

Lily's Quest for the Magical Plant

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Part One

Lily woke with a bright idea. Sunlight tickled her toes. Her red boots waited by the door. Teddy smiled from the chair. Today was the day for an adventure.

« **Can I go to the little forest, please?** » Lily asked. Her mama nodded and tied a tiny scarf around Lily's neck. « **Stay close, listen, and call me if you need me,** » her mama said. Lily hugged her tight. « **I will,** » she promised.

The little forest was at the end of the garden. It was not big. It smelled of leaves and sweet grass. But to Lily it felt like a whole world. Trees stood like friendly giants. Shadows played like soft animals on the path. A bird sang a happy song.

Lily skipped in. She held Teddy's paw. She looked for the magical plant. It was a rare plant said to glow a little like moonlight and sing in the wind. Grandpa had told her the story. Lily wanted to see it. She wanted to help the garden be bright.

« **Follow the pebble path,** » said a squirrel, or so Lily thought. She laughed. She liked pretending animals talked. She listened to the forest sound. Crunch, crunch. Tap, tap. Chirp, chirp.

Part Two

The first obstacle was a little stream. Water bubbled over pebbles and made silver circles. The water looked cold. Lily sat and watched. Teddy shivered.

Lily counted pebbles. One, two, three. She found flat stones. She made a stepping path. « **Step on the stones,** » she told Teddy. Step. Step. Step. They crossed the stream. Lily felt brave.

A tall flower bent over the path next. It tickled Lily's face. She giggled and pushed it gently. The flower smelled like honey. She thought of her mama's tea.

« **Hello, tall flower,** » Lily said. The flower bobbed like a hat.

Soon the forest grew a bit darker. Not scary dark. Just the kind of dark where the leaves make cozy shade. Lily walked softly. She hummed a tune. She hummed to make the shadows friendly. She held Teddy warm.

Then Lily found a patch of prickly leaves. Ouch, she touched one and it prickled her hand. She sat down. She felt a small tear. « **It hurts,** » she whispered. A robin hopped near. The robin pecked a soft leaf and gave it to Lily like a bandage. « **Thank you,** » Lily said. She blew on her finger and smiled. She moved slowly and found a new path that was soft and safe.

A fallen log lay across the trail like a sleeping dragon. « **We must climb,** » Lily decided. She put Teddy on her head like a captain's hat. She counted one, two, three and climbed. Her feet were a little shaky, but she did it. At the top she paused and looked. The forest was a sea of green. The sky peeked through like a blue patchwork quilt.

At the log's end a glimmer caught her eye. A tiny blue light danced behind a cluster of leaves. It was small and shy. Lily tiptoed closer. The air smelled like mint. Her heart thumped like a little drum. She felt brave and also a bit nervous. That was okay. She took a deep breath. She remembered her mama's words: « **You are smart, you are kind, you are brave.** »

A little mouse peeked from a hole. « **Are you looking for the magical plant?** » the mouse squeaked. Lily nodded. « **Yes,** » she said. The mouse showed her a map on a leaf. It had a tiny X drawn with seed juice. Lily followed the map. She decided to sing softly so the plant would know she was a friend.

Part Three

At the heart of the forest, under a big fern, Lily found a circle of tiny lights. The magical plant sat in the middle. It had a single round leaf that shimmered like a

sleepy star. The plant hummed a soft song. Lily knelt. The plant shivered and glowed a little more.

Lily whispered, « **Hello, little plant.** » She touched the leaf. It felt cool and kind. She thought of Mama's garden and how the plant could help the flowers grow bright. The plant gave a tiny chime sound, like a bell made of dew.

Just then a breeze blew a loose branch. The branch knocked Teddy into a puddle. Teddy's fur was wet. Lily felt a little rush in her chest. She wanted to cry. But she breathed slowly. She was brave. She wrapped Teddy in her scarf. She gently patted him dry. « **It's okay,** » she sang. Teddy's smile returned.

Lily knew the plant needed a safe home. She scooped some soft moss and a few small stones into a shallow pot she found near an old root. She sang to the plant while she planted it in the moss. « **Grow big and kind,** » she hummed. The plant glowed like a tiny lantern. It seemed to nod.

On her walk back, Lily met her mama at the garden gate. Mama was smiling and holding a glass jar with a lid for the plant. « **Did you find it?** » Mama asked. Lily showed the tiny plant. The plant glowed and hummed like a lullaby. « **We will keep it safe,** » Lily promised. Mama scooped the plant gently into the jar and put soft moss around it. « **We will plant it in our sunny patch,** » Mama said. Lily clapped her hands.

That night, Lily tucked Teddy into bed. She watched the jar on her bedside table. The plant glowed softly, like a night light. Lily felt warm inside. She had been brave. She had been smart. She had been kind. She had helped.

« **Tomorrow we will check on the plant,** » Mama said as she kissed Lily's forehead. « **We will water it and tell it stories.** » Lily smiled and closed her eyes. The room felt safe and bright. The little plant hummed a sleepy song.

Lily dreamed of pebble paths and singing plants. She dreamed of stepping stones and friendly birds. She dreamed of many small adventures. In the morning, the garden would be waiting. The sun would tickle her toes again. Lily

breathed in and whispered, « **I will go on more quests,** » and then she fell into a gentle sleep, full of happy plans.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What did Lily want to find in the little forest?

- A magical plant
- A big tree
- A treasure chest
- A friendly giant

2) Who helped Lily when she got a prickly leaf?

- A bunny
- A robin
- A squirrel
- A butterfly

3) What did Lily use to cross the stream?

- A boat
- A bridge
- Stepping stones
- A magic wand

4) What did Lily do with the magical plant at the end?

- She ate it
- She put it in a jar
- She gave it to a friend
- She threw it away

Correct answers:

1) A magical plant 2) A robin 3) Stepping stones 4) She put it in a jar

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Adventure: An exciting or unusual experience or journey.

Giggle: A light and silly laugh.

Obstacle: Something that makes it difficult to do something.

Shimmered: To shine with a soft, wavering light.

Brave: Showing courage; not afraid.

Gentle: Kind and mild; not harsh or rough.